

QMAX Quadrant

Though the 1.7 GHz is not a top-of-the-class PC, it houses sufficient power to see you through most applications. The 32 MB AGP card delivers playable frame rates for your 3D games, while the 128 MB of SDRAM gives you a more affordable upgrade path if you do not need too much power. With support for 3 GB RAM and two free PCI slots, you have reasonable expansion capability. It comes with a 15-inch monitor that goes up to a resolution of 1024x768 at an 85 Hz refresh rate. The system provides all basic level components that a user would expect such as a PS/2 keyboard, mouse, a 52x CD-ROM drive and two channel audio support. It also has a reasonably powerful stereo speaker system. Completing the package is a 56K PCI modem.

The system is lacking on the software front—it bundles just the operating system (Windows XP Home Edition) and a 100-hour Satyam Internet pack. However, with a price tag of Rs 39,000, it's a decent choice for those on a budget.

Suitability to Task Index

Gaming	3.91
Productivity	5.72
Office apps/Internet	5.29

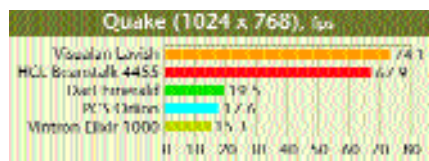
cordless mouse was very smooth and well suited for the accuracy needed in *Quake III Arena* rail-gun matches! Since it has a CD-RW drive too, you can easily copy your home videos onto VCDs and archive your bank of DivX movies and other files. This drive logged a commendable score of 3.48 MBps in the sequential read test.

The Visualan Lavish was rivalled by the HCL Beanstalk 4455 in the gaming and entertainment tests. This PC was armed with a powerful configuration of 2.4 GHz Pentium 4 processor, 256 MB of DDR RAM and the *piece de resistance*—the two 40 GB 7,200-rpm Seagate Barracuda hard disk drives configured in RAID-0. This method of implementing hard disk storage enabled it to achieve a sequential read/write data transfer rate of 43 MBps and 40 MBps, respectively. The graphics subsystem was also very robust with the ASUS V8170 graphics card coupled with a 17-inch monitor, but a faster graphics card would have done this system much good in the gaming arena. For gamers who like to hear the resonance of rockets exploding around them, the 2.1 Altec Lansing speakers did a good job of delivering the audio experience.

Finally, movie buffs will be delighted with the 16x Pioneer slot-in DVD drive. The drive did especially well in the tests, where it logged a data transfer rate of over 3 MBps in the sequential read test. The four USB ports make enough space for

the gaming peripherals you may want to upgrade to.

The HCL Beanstalk 4455 also delivered reasonably good performance



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